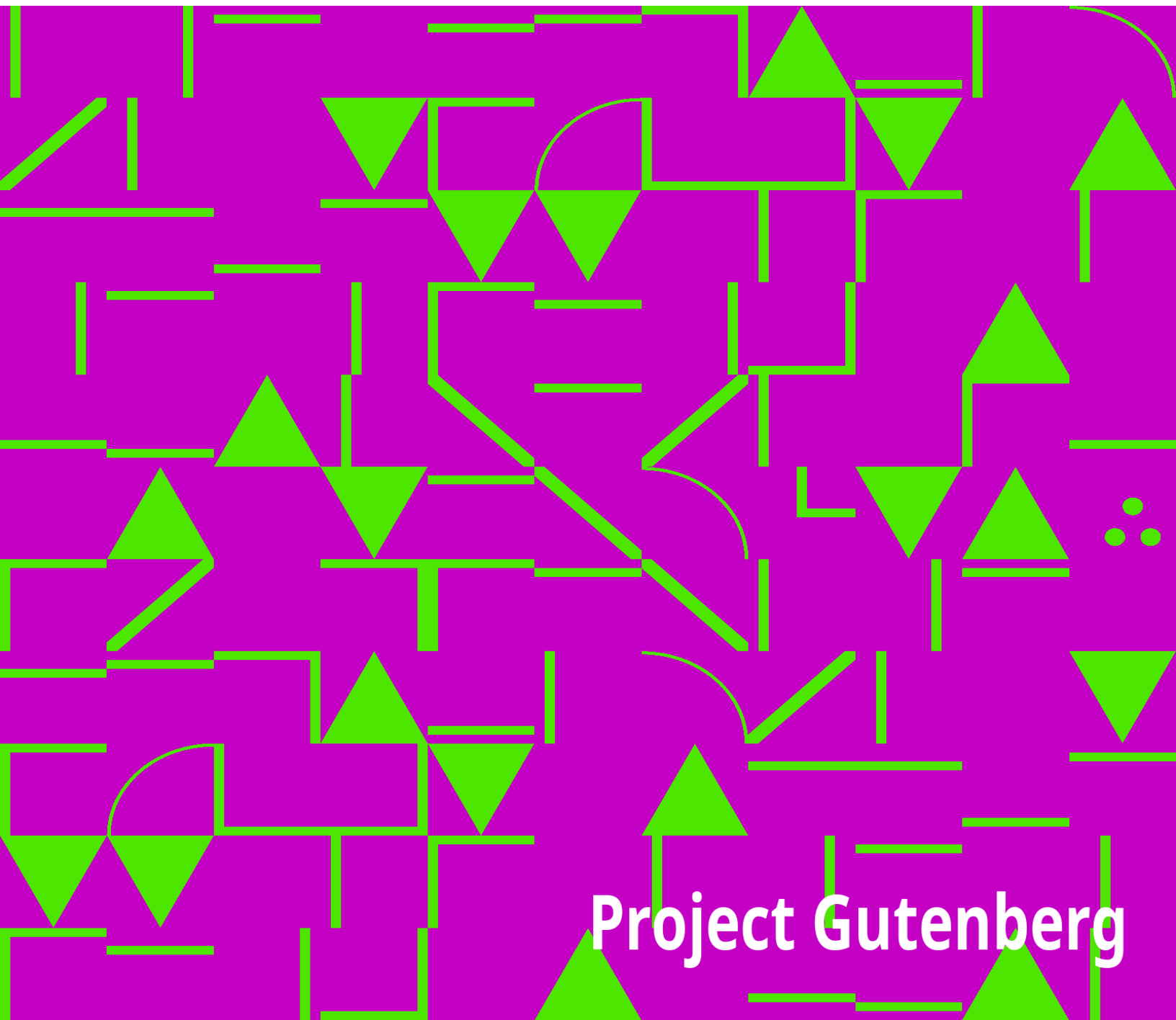


The Departing Soul's Address to the Body: A Fragment of a Semi-Saxon Poem

Sir Thomas Phillipps



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DEPARTING SOUL'S ADDRESS TO THE BODY: A FRAGMENT OF A
SEMI-SAXON POEM ***

THE

DEPARTING SOUL'S

ADDRESS TO THE BODY

A FRAGMENT OF

A SEMI-SAXON POEM,
DISCOVERED AMONG THE ARCHIVES OF WORCESTER
CATHEDRAL,

BY SIR THOMAS PHILLIPPS, BART.

WITH AN ENGLISH TRANSLATION,

BY

S. W. SINGER.

**LONDON:
PRINTED BY LUKE JAMES HANSARD & CO.**

M.DCCC.XLV.

The student of our early literature and language is indebted to the zeal of Sir Thomas Phillipps, for the discovery of the following interesting Fragment, which appears to have formed part of a volume that contained Ælfric's Grammar and Glossary, probably of the Twelfth Century. The fragments were discovered among the archives of Worcester Cathedral; and in 1836 Sir Thomas Phillipps printed the whole of them in folio. I know not whether the form or the typographical arrangement has been the cause of the neglect of this publication; but it has escaped both Mr. Wright and Mr. Thorpe. The former, in his interesting edition of "The Latin Poems of Walter de Mapes," where he has given the literary history of this legend with extracts, has not even referred to our fragment; nor has Mr. Thorpe adverted to it in his publication of the "Codex Exoniensis," which contains an Anglo-Saxon poem of the same kind, with which it is interesting to compare this later version of the legend. There is a portion of another semi-Saxon poem, entitled "The Grave," printed in Mr. Conybeare's

"Illustrations," and by Mr. Thorpe in his "Analecta Anglo-Saxonica," which appears to be by the same hand, or at any rate of the same school and age. Indeed some of the lines and thoughts are identical with passages of the following poem. Mr. Thorpe has justly called "The Grave" a singularly impressive and almost appalling fragment; expressions equally characteristic of that with which the reader is here presented.

This impressive character, coupled with the interest which the fragment possesses, as a specimen of the moral poetry of our ancestors, and as throwing light upon the transition of our language from Saxon to English, has been the motive for producing it in a more legible form than that in which it first appeared.

In one of the smaller poems (No. V.), printed by Mr. Wright with the Owl and the Nightingale, from the Cottonian MS. Calig. A. ix. "The sorie sowle maketh hire mone," in language not dissimilar to that used in the following fragment; and the dreary imagery of the house appointed for all living, and the punishment which awaits a wicked life at its close, are painted in an equally fearful manner.

*Mr. Thorpe points to an Anglo-Saxon prose Homily as the original of the poem on the same theme in the Exeter MS., which is repeated, with some variation, in the Vercelli Codex. In a rude and simple age this dramatic way of awakening the sinner to a sense of his perilous state, was perhaps the most effective that could have been chosen, and it was naturally a favorite with the moral and religious teachers for some centuries. M. Karajan, in a very pleasing little publication (*Frühlingsgabe für freunde Alterer Literatur*, Wien 1839) has printed the "Visio Philiberti," a Latin poem in dialogue on this subject, with two old German versions; and the notes contain some interesting information relating to similar compositions; but Mr. Wright's volume, before referred to, contains ample illustrations of the legend in all languages.*

The fragment here given, it will be seen, is very defective. An attempt has been made to supply words which were wanting, from the mutilation of the MS. leaves; but what is engrafted on the original is scrupulously distinguished by the Italic character. A version has also been added, the

imperfections of which those who are acquainted with the difficulties of such renderings will best know how to excuse.

*The language of this poem seems to have a striking resemblance to that of one of the MSS. of *Lazamon*, and we may hope, when the lovers of our early lore shall be favoured with the long and anxiously expected edition of that work by Sir Frederick Madden, that much light will be thrown upon the history of the transitions of our language.*

For what has been already done by Conybeare, Price, Kemble, Thorpe, Madden, Stevenson, Wright, Way and others, the present writer is most grateful; but he would wish to see the same spirit and enthusiasm, the same unwearied zeal displayed in the elucidation of the noble remains of our Anglo-Saxon ancestors, and of the interesting stores of our early literature and language, which has been so long a distinguishing feature of Germany, whose example has of late years lighted up a similar patriotic flame in France and Belgium.

Mickleham, August 20, 1844.

THE

DEPARTING SOUL'S ADDRESS TO THE BODY.

* * * * en earde.
and alle theo isceæfestan.
the him to * * *
and mid muchele *wisdome*.
thonne mon he idihte.
and him on ileide.
lif and soule.
softliche he heo isomne.
ac thær bith sor idol.
that bodeth that bearn.
thonne hit iboren bith.
hit *woaneth* and mænet theo
weowe.
and thene seoruhfule sith.
and that sori idol.
that soule schal *hire licame*.
sorliche idælen.
Forthon hit cumeth weopinde.
and woniende iwiteth.
thonne Death mid his pricke.
pineth thene licame.
He walketh and wendeth.
and woneth *his sithes*.
he sæith on his bedde.
wo me that ic libbe.
that æffre min lif dawes.
thus *longe* me ilesteth.

* * * *
* * * *
* * * *
and with much *wisdom*
5 then man he framed,
bestowed on him
life and soul,
tenderly he united them;
but there is a sad portion
10 which awaits that child.
When it is born;
it waileth, and bemoans the woe,
and the sorrowful time,
and that sad lot,
15 that shall the soul from her body
sadly separate.
Therefore it cometh weeping,
and wailing departeth,
when Death, with his dart,
20 pineth the body.
He walketh and goeth,
and bewails his destiny;
he saith, on his bed,
Wo me! that I live;
25 that ever my life
so long endureth.

for heui is his greoning.
and seohrful is his woaning.
and all *reowliche* his sith.
mid seorwe biwunden.
him deaueth tha æren.
him dimmeth *tha* eißen.
him scerpeth the neose.
him scrincketh tha lippen.
him scorteth *the* tunge.
him truketh his iwit.
him teoreth his miht.
him coldeth his *heorte*.
him leggeth the ban stille.
thonne bith that soule hus.
seoruhliche bereaved.
of also muchele wunne.
the ther inne wunede
thus bith thæs bearnes.
mid pinunge ifulled.
theo moder greoneth.
and that bearn woaneth.
so bith theo *heardtid*.
mid balewen imenged.
So bith eft the feorthsith.
sorhliche to *dæled*
mid seoruwen al bewunden.
thonne the licame and the sowle.
soriliche to *dæleth*.
thonne bith that wræcche lif.
iended al mid sori sith.
thonne bith the *bodige*.
iflut to then flore.
he bith eastward istreiht.

For heavy is his groaning,
and sorrowful his wailing.
and all rueful his lot,
30 with sorrow encompassed.
His ears deafen,
his eyes become dim,
his nose sharpens,
his lips shrink,
35 his tongue shorteneth
his sense faileth,
his strength wasteth,
his *heart* chilleth,
his bones lie still;
40 then is that soul-house
wofully bereaved
of as much delight
as therein dwelled.
Thus are these children
45 filled with torment;
The mother groaneth,
and the child wailleth;
so is that hard hap
with torment mingled.
50 So is oft the departure,
miserably apportioned,
with sorrow all surrounded,
when the body and the soul
sorrowfully separate.
55 Then is that wretched life
ended all with sad departure;
then is the body
banished to the floor;
he is stretcht eastward;

he bith sone stif.
 he *heardeth* also clei.
 hit is him ikunde.
 mon hine met mit on 3erde.
 and tha *molde* seoththen.
 ne mot he of thære molde.
 habben namore.
 thonne that rihte imet.
rihtliche tæcheth.
 Thonne lith the clei clot.
 cold on then flore.
 and him sone from *fleoth*.
 theo he ær freome dude.
 nulleth heo mid honden.
 his heafod riht wenden.
 heom thuncheth that hore honden.
 swuthe beoth ifuled.
 gif heo hondleth the *dæde*.
 Seoththen his deazes beoth igon.
 sone cumeth that wrecche wif.
forhoweth thene earfeth sith.
 forbindeth thæs dædan muth.
 and his dimme eizen.
 * * * *ie* thet riche^[A] wif.
forhoweth thene earueth sith.
 for ufel is that wrecche lufe.
thonne theo unblisse cumath.
 Thonne besihth theo soule.
sorliche to then lichame.
 * * * * *
hwi noldest bethenchen thu me.
 theo hwule thet ic wunede inne
 the.

60 he is soon stiff;
 he hardens like clay;
 it is of kin to him.
 They measure him with a yard,
 and that dust, thenceforth,
 65 may not of the earth
 have any more
 than that right measured
 rightly teacheth.
 Then lies the clay clod
 70 cold on the floor,
 and soon from him *flee*
 those he before help did;
 nor will they, with *their* hands,
 lay his head straight;
 75 they think that their hands
 are much defiled
 if they handle the dead.
 After his days are gone,
 soon cometh the wretched wife,
 80 lamenteth the woeful time,
 binds up the mouth of the dead,
 and closes his dim eyes.
 * * * that wretched wife
 lamenteth the woeful time;
 85 for evil is that wretched love
 when adversity cometh.
 Then saith the soul
 sadly to the body,
 * * * * *
 90 *why wouldst thou not think of me*
 while that I dwelt in thee,

for thou were leas and lutiȝ.
 and *unriht* lufedest.
 godnesse and riht.
 æfre thou onscunedest.
 hwar is nu the *modinesse*.
 swo muchel the thou lufedæst.
 hwar beoth nu theo pundes.
 thurh * * * newes igædered.
 heo weren monifolde.
 bi markes itolde.
 hwar beoth *nu* theo goldfæten.
 theo the guldene.
 comen to thine honden.
 thin blisse is *nu* al igon.
 min seoruwe is fornnon.
 hwar beoth nu thin wæde.
 the thou wel lufedest.
 hwar beoth the.
 seten sori ofer the.
 beden swuthe ȝeorne.
that the come bote.
 heom thuthte alto longe.
 that thou were on live.
 for heo weren grædie.
 to gripen thin æiht.
 nu heo hi dælith heom imang.
heo doth the withuten.
 ac nu heo beoth fuse.
 to bringen the ut of huse.
 bergen the ut æt thire dure.
 Of weolen thou art bedæled.

for thou wert false and deceitful,
 and iniquity didst love;
 goodness and justice
 ever thou didst shun.
 Where is now the pride
 thou so much didst love?
 Where are now the pounds
 by * * * gathered?
 they were manifold,
 counted by marks.
 Where are now the vessels of
 gold
 that thou idolized,
 as they came to thy hands?
 Thy bliss is now all gone;
 my sorrow is near.
 Where are now thy clothes
 that thou well didst love?
 Where are they
 that sate sorry over thee,
 praying right earnestly
 that help *might* come to thee?
 They thought it all too long
 that thou wert alive,
 for they were greedy
 to gripe thy property.
 Now they divide it among them,
 they do without thee,
 eke now they are prompt
 to bring thee out of house;
 bearing thee out at the door.
 Of wealth thou art deprived.

Hwui noldest *thu* bethenchen me.

theo hwile ic was innen the.

ac scendest me mid sunne.

forthi ic seoruhful eam.

weile that ic souhte.

so seoruhfulne buc.

noldest *thu* *lokien* lufe.

with ilærede men.

ȝiven ham of thine gode.

that heo the fore beden.

heo mihten mid salm songe.

thine sunne acwenchen.

mid * * * reinesse.

thine misdeden forebiddan.

heo mihten offrian loc.

leofliche for the.

swuth deor thurthe lac.

licame Cristes.

thurh thære *thu* wære.

alesed from helle wite.

and mid his reade blode.

that he ȝeat on rode.

the *thu* weren ifreoed.

to farene into heouene.

ac *thu* fenge to theowdome.

thurh thæs *deofles* lore.

Bi the hit is iseid.

and soth hit is on boken.

Qui custodiat divitias.

Servus est divitiis.

Thou were theow.

thines weolan.

Why wouldst thou not think of
me

while I was within thee?

but blemished me with sin.

Therefore I sorrowful am;

alas! that I sought

such a miserable body.

Nor wouldst thou observe love

with learned men,

give them part of thy wealth

that they *might* pray for thee,

that they might with psalm sung

thy sin extinguish,

with * * *

pray for thy misdeeds;

that they might offer gifts

acceptable for thee,

through the most dear sacrifice

of Christ's body;

by which thou were

redeemed from pains of hell;

and with his red blood,

that he shed on the cross,

by which thou wert freed

to enter into heaven.

But thou took to thraldom

through the devil's lore.

Concerning thee it is said

in books, and true it is:

Qui custodiat divitias,

Servus est divitiis.

Thou wert slave

to thy wealth,

noldest thu nouht.
 thærof *dælen*.
 for Drihtenes willæn.
 ac æfre thu grædiliche,
 gæderdest the more.
 lutherliche eart thu forloren.
 from al that thu lufedest.
 and ic scal wræcche soule.
ece we nu driæn.

 eart thu nu loth and unwurth.
 alle thine freonden.
 nu ham *thuncheth* alto long.
 that thu ham neih list.
 ær thu beo ibrouht.
 thær thu *begrafen* scalt.
 on deope sæthe.
 on durelease huse.
 thær wurmes wældeth.
 alle *that* wurthest was.
 fuweles quale holde.
 the thu icwemedest ær.
 mid alre *kunde* swetnesse.
 theo thu swuthe lufedest.
 theo swetnesse is nu al agon.
 that *bittere* the bith fornon.
 that bittere ilæsteth æffre.
 that swete ne cumeth the *næffre*.
 * * * * *
thuncheth that thu hire *bileiben*.
 ȝet sæith theo sowle.
 soriliche to then licame.
 sæ *ne thearft* thu on stirope.

155 nor wouldst thou ought
 thereof distribute
 for God's pleasure;
 but thou ever greedily
 didst gather the more.
 160 Miserably art thou separated
 from all that thou lovedst,
 and I, wretched soul, shall
 now suffer everlasting woe.
 Thou art now loathsome and
 contemptible
 165 to all thy friends.
 Now they think it all too long
 that thou liest nigh them,
 ere thou be brought
 where thou shalt be buried
 170 in a deep pit,
 in a doorless house,
 where worms possess
 all that was most honoured
 of the foul dead carcase,
 175 that thou formerly delightedst
 with all kind of sweetness,
 that thou much didst love.
 The sweetness is now all gone,
 the bitter is thee near,
 180 that bitter lasteth ever,
 that sweet cometh to thee never.
 * * * * *
 thinketh that thou here remain.
 Yet saith the soul
 185 sadly to the body:
 see, thou canst not on stirrup

stonden mid fotan.
on nenne goldfohne bowe.
for thu *scalt* faren alto howe.
and thu scalt nu ruglunge.
ridæn to thære eorthe.
ut *sceot* æt thære dure.
ne thearft thu næffre onʒean.
cumæn reowliche riden.
nu alle beræfed.
ac thene eorthliche weole.
the thu iwold ohtest.
nu mon mæi *seggen* bi the.
thes mon is iwiten.
nu her weila.
and his weolæn beoth her
belæfed.
 nolde he nefre thær of don.
his drihtenes wille.
ac æfre thu gæderest.
gærsumen thine feonde.
nulleth heo nimen gete.
hwo hit biʒete.
nafst thu bute *welawei*.
that thu weole heuedest.
al is reowliche thin sith.
efter thin wrecche lif.
theo men beoth the blithre.
the arisen ær with the.
that thin muth is betuned.
the theo teone ut lettest.
the he heom sore grulde.
thet ham gros the aʒan.
dæth hine haveth bituned.

stand with thy feet,
on no gold-glittering saddle;
for thou shalt journey all to woe,
190 and thou shalt now backwards
ride to the earth;
shut out at the door,
nor canst thou ever again
come fiercely riding.
195 Now all bereaved,
eke the earthly wealth,
that thou possessed power *over*.
Now they may say of thee,
this man is departed,
200 Alas! now here,
and his wealth is here left behind.
he would never do therewith
his Lord's will.
But ever thou didst gather
205 riches of thine enemies.
Yet will they not take
who procured it?
nor hast thou but well away!
that thou hadst wealth.
210 All ruefull is thy lot,
after thy wicked life.
Those men are the blither
that formerly jangled with thee,
that thy mouth is closed,
215 with which thou reproach uttered,
which sorely provoked them;
that they raged against thee;
death hath closed it,

and thene teone aleid.
Soth is iseid.
on then salme *bec*.
Os tuum habundavit malitia,
was on thine muthe.
luthernesse ripe.
noldest thou on thine huse.
herborwen theo wrecchen.
ne mihten heo under *thine* roue.
none reste finden.
noldest thou næfre helpen.
tham orlease *wrecchen*.
ac thou sete on thine benche.
underleid mid thine bolstre.
thou wurpe *cneow* ofer *cneow*.
ne icneowe thou the sulfen.
that thou scoldest mid wurmen.
husien in eorthan.
nu thou hauest neowe hus.
inne bethrunge.
lowe beoth the helewewes.
unheize beoth the sidwoves.
thin rof liith on thin breoste full
nei.
colde is the ibedded.
clothes bidcled.
nulleth thine hinen.
clothes the sen * * *
for heom thuncheth alto lut.
that thou heom bilefdest.
that thou hefdest on *horde*.
theo hit wulleth heldan.
thus is iwitan thin weole.

and the anger taken away.
220 Truly it is said
in the Psalm book,
os tuum habundavit malitia,
wickedness ripe
was in thy mouth.
225 Thou wouldst not in thy house
shelter the poor,
nor might they under thy roof
find any rest;
nor wouldst thou ever help
230 the unhappy wretches;
but thou sate on thy bench,
underlaid with thy bolster,
thou threw knee over knee,
nor knew thou thyself
235 that thou shouldst with worms
dwell in the earth.
Now thou hast a new house,
a crowded dwelling;
low is the covering,
240 unhigh the sidewalls,
thy roof lieth on thy breast full
nigh.
Cold art thou embedded,
beclad in clothes
thy hinds would refuse.
245 Clothes the sen * * *
for they think all too little
that thou didst leave them;
that thou hadst in hoard
they will it keep.
250 Thus is departed thy wealth,

wendest thet hit thin were.
 thus *reowliche* nu thin sith.
 efter thin wrecche lif.
 the sculen nu waxen.
 wurmes besiden.
thene hungrie feond.
 theo the freten wulleth.
 heo wulleth the frecliche freten.
 for *heo* thin flæsc liketh.
 heo wulleth freten thin fule hold.
 theo hwule heo hit *findeth*.
 thonne hit al bith agon.
 heo wulleth gnawen thin bon.
 theo orlease wurmes.
 heo windeth on thin armes.
 heo breketh thine breoste.
 and borieth the ofer al.
heo reoweth in and ut.
 thet hord is hore open.
 and so heo wulleth waden.
 wide in thi *wombe*.
 todelen thine thermes.
 theo the deore weren.
 lifre and thine lihte.
lodliche torenden.
 and so scal formelten.
 mawe and thin milte.
 and so scal win * * *
 * * * * *
 wurmes of thine flæsc.
 thu scalt fostren thine feond.
 thet thu beo al ifreten
thu scalt nu herborwen.

255 *thou* thoughtest that it thine were.
 Thus ruefull now thy lot,
 after thy wretched life.
 Now wormes shall grow
 beside thee,
 the hungry enemy
 that will devour thee,
 they will thee greedily devour;
 for they like thy flesh,
 260 they will devour thy foul carcase,
 as long as they find it;
 when it is all gone
 they will gnaw thy bone;
 those vile worms,
 265 they wind on thy arms,
 they break up thy breast,
 and perforate thee all over;
 they rove in and out,
 that hoard is open to them,
 and so they will wade
 270 wide in thy stomach;
 parting thy entrails
 that were dear to thee.
 Thy liver and thy lights
 275 loathfully rending,
 and so shall waste away
 thy maw and thy melt,
 and so shall win * * *
 * * * * *
 280 worms of thy flesh,
 thou shalt nourish thine enemy
 until thou art all devoured;
 thou shalt now harbour

unhol wihte.		hateful creatures,
noldest thu ær gode men.	285	(heretofore thou wouldst not, good men,
for lufe gode sellan.		for love, give <i>of thy</i> goods;)
heo wulleth wurchen hore hord.		they will work their hoard
on thine heaued ponne.		in thy skull.
moton heo bileafen.		Should they leave
thine lippen unfreten.	290	thy lips undevoured,
ac thu scalt grisliche grennien.		eke thou shalt grin horribly,
<i>that</i> hwo so hit iseize.		that whosoever sees it
he mihte beon offered.		he might be frightened;
Reowliche bith so thin sith.		so rueful is thy lot,
after <i>thin</i> wercche lif.	295	after thy wicked life.
nu me wule swopen thine flor.		Now men will sweep thy floor,
and thet flet clensien.		and cleanse the dwelling;
for hit is heom lothre.		for it is the loather to them
the thu theron leize.		that thou liest thereon.
heo wulleth mid holiwatere.	300	They will, with holy water,
beworpen ec theo <i>pædas</i> .		sprinkle eke the vestments,
blecsien ham 3eorne.		cleansing them carefully
to burewen ham with the.		to bury them with thee;
beren ut thin bed strau.		bear out thy bed-straw
<i>brennen</i> hit mid fure.	305	to burn it with fire.
thus thu ert nu ilufed.		Thus thou art now beloved
seoththen thu me forlure.		since thou lost me.
al hit is reowliche thin sith.		All rueful is thy lot,
after thin wrecche lif.		after thy wicked life.
3et sæith the soule.	310	Yet saith the soul
soriliche to hire licame.		sadly to the body,
<i>noldest</i> thu la erming.		Alas! miserable, wouldst thou not
her o to wunienne.		here for ever dwell?
nes hit the no wiht icunde.		it was no whit known to thee
that thu icoren <i>me</i> hefdest.	315	that thou hadst chosen me;

nes hit icunde the.
more then thine cunne biuoren
the.
ne heold is thin *æize* opene.
theo hwule ic the inne was.
hwi noldest thu lefen.
tha thu hi iseize.
hu thin *fordferen*.
ferden biforen the.
nu heo wunieth on eorthe.
wurmes ham habbeth todæled.
isceorf hore sorhfulle bones.
the theo sunne wrohten.
tha 3et seith theo soule.
soriliche to hire *lichame*.
æfre thu were luther.
theo hwile thu lif hæfdest.
thu were leas and luti.
and unriht lufedest.
and luthere deden.
deredest cristene men.
and mid worde and mid werke.
so thu wurst mihte.
ic was from Gode clene.
to the isend.
ac thu hauest unc fordon.
mid thine luthere deden.
æfre thu were gredi.
and mid gromen the onfulled.
unneathe ic on the.
eni wununge *hauede*.
for hearde nithe.
and ofer mete fulle.

it was not known to thee
more than to thy kin before thee,
nor was thine eye held open
while I was within thee.
320 Why wouldst thou not believe,
though thou saw it,
how thy forefathers
went before thee.
Now they dwell in the earth,
325 worms have shared them,
gnawed their miserable bones
with which they wrought sin.
Again saith the soul,
sorrowfully to the body,
330 thou wert ever wicked
whilst thou hadst life,
thou wert false and deceitful,
and loved injustice
and wicked deeds,
335 and injured Christian men
with word and with work,
as thou worst might.
I was sent to thee
innocent from God,
340 but thou hast undone us,
with thy wicked deeds.
Ever thou wert greedy,
and filled thyself with fierceness,
I hardly in thee
345 had any dwelling,
for hard covetousness,
and foul gluttony;

for thin wombe was thin god.
and thin wulder *thu* iscend.
forloren thu havest theo ece
blisse.
binumen thu havest the paradis.
binumen the is that holi lond.
then deofle thu bist isold on hond.
for noldest thu nefre *habben*
inouh.
buten thu hefdest unifouh.
Nu is that swete al agon.
thet bittere the *bith* fornon.
that bittere ilest the efre.
thet gode ne cumeth the nefre.
thus ageth nu thin *sith*.
æfter thin wrecce lif.
thu wendest that thin ende.
nefre ne cuman scolde.
to long * * * lede death the.
that he nolde nimen the.
for efre thu arerdest sake.
and unseihte * * *
and ic was with innen the.
biclused swuthe fule.
thu were wedlowe.
and mon sware.
and * * * hund inouh.
for thu were mid sunne.
ifulled al with inne.
for the deofle *lored the all*.
ord fulneih thine heorte.

for thy belly was thy god,
and thou spoiled thy glory.
350 Lost thou hast everlasting bliss,
thou hast deprived thee of
Paradise.
Taken from thee is that holy land;
thou art given into the devil's
hand,
for thou wouldst never have
enough,
355 unless thou hadst repletion.
Now is the sweet all gone,
the bitter is near thee,
that bitter lasteth thee ever,
that good cometh to thee never.
360 Thus goeth now thy lot,
after thy wicked life.
Thou thoughtest that thine end
should never come.
Too long * * * death thee,
365 that he would not take thee,
for thou ever raised up strife
and discord, * * *
and I was within thee
most foully enclosed;
370 thou wert faithless
and perjured,
and * * * enough;
for thou wert with sin
filled all within,
375 for the devil taught thee all,
chief full nigh thy heart.

efre thu woldest fullen.
al that was his wille.

* * * * *

* * * thu nefre th.

drihtenes * * *

* * * *i*wold ahte.

The 3et seith theo soule.
soriliche to hire licame.
clene bith the eor*the*.

ær thu to hire to cume.

ac thu heo afulest.

mid thin fule holde.

thet is that *fulnesse*.

afursed from monnen.

nu thu bist bihuded.

on alre horde fulest.

on *deope* seathe.

on durelease huse.

thu scalt rotien.

and brostnian.

thine bon beoth bedæled.

from *thære* wæde.

the heo weren to iwunede.

breketh lith from lithe.

liggeth the bon stil.

tha ure drihten eft.

of deathe heo aræreth.

so he alle men deth.

thonne domes daie *cumeth*.

thonne scalt thu erming.

up arisen.

imeten thine morth deden.

theo the murie weren.

Ever thou wouldst fulfil,
all that was his will.

* * * * *

380 * * * * *

* * * * *

* * * * *

385 Again, saith the soul,
sadly to the body,
the earth is pure

e'er thou come to it,

but thou defilest it

with thy foul carcase;

only that foulness is

390 removed from men;

now thou art hidden

in foulest hoard,

in a deep pit,

in a doorless house.

395 Thou shalt rot

and corrupt;

thy bones will be separated

from the clothing

in which they were inhabited;

400 limb breaks from limb;

the bones lie still,

until our Lord again

from death raiseth them,

as he doth all men,

405 when doomsday cometh.

Then shalt thou, miserable!

up arise,

thy deadly sins measured,

that were so pleasant to thee;

seoruhful and sorimod.
so thin lif wrouhte.
nu beoth thine earen fordutte.
non dreame ihereth.
theo leorneden theo listen.
tha luthere weren.
[*mid*] wowe domes.
and gultes *feole*.
thu othre beræfedest.
rihtes istreones.
thurh thæs deofles lore,
theo the likede wel.
the *deofle* tuhte his hearpe.
and tuhte the to him.
thu iherdest thene dream.
he was drihtene fullloth.
he swefede the.
mid then sweize.
swote thu sleptest.
longe on thine bedde.
nis the to chirche.
ne mostes thu iheren.
theo holie dræmes.
theo bellen rungen.
that siker becnunge wæs.
ne holie lore.
the unker helpe wære.
ac efre he tuhte the.
andnu beo the iwold ahte.
ac nu beoth fordutte.
thine dream thurles.
ne ihereth heo *ne* more.
non herunge of the.

410 sorrowful and melancholy,
the crimes of thy life.
Now are thine ears closed,
no pleasant sounds they hear;
they learned, they listened
415 to those that were wicked.
With unjust judgments,
and many trespasses,
thou others bereaved
of rightful wealth,
420 through the devil's lore,
that thou liked well.
The *devil* touched his harp,
and enticed thee to him;
thou heardest the harmony;
425 it was hateful to the Lord.
He lulled thee
with the sound;
sweetly thou sleptest
long in thy bed;
430 nor art thou at church,
nor canst thou hear
those holy sounds,
the bells tolling,
that a sure beckoning was;
435 nor holy lore
that should be our help.
But ever he enticed thee,
and now thou art in his power;
eke now are closed
440 thy doors of sound,
nor hear they more
any praise of thee,

ær theo bemen blowen.
the unc becnien scullen.
from deathes dimnesse.
to drihtenes dome.
thonne thu scalt iheren.
thene *lauerde* dom.
the thu on thisse life.
lutherliche of eodest.
Thet et seith the sowle.
soriliche to hire licame.
nu thu bist afursed.
from alle thine freonden.
nu is thin muth forscutted.
for death hine haueth fordutted.
ne bith he *ne mare* undon.
ær cume thæs heiȝe kinges dom.
thonne hit bith isene.
thet on Psalme seith.
Reddituri sunt de factis propriis
rationem.
thonne sculen theo weile.
seggen hore deden.
wisliche thurh wisdom.
for drihten hit wot.
thonne heo onfoth hore dom.
of drihtenes muthe.
also hit is awriten.
of *drihtenes* muthe.
Ite maledicti in ignem eternum.
thonne sculen wit *sithien*.
to alre seoruwe mest.
faren mid feondes.
in thet eche fur.

until the trumpets blow
which shall summon us
445 from death's dimness
to the Lord's doom.
Then thou shalt hear
the Lord doom,
that thou in this life
wickedly walked.
450 Again saith the soul
sadly to the body,
now thou art separated
from all thy friends;
455 now is thy mouth prevented,
for death has closed it;
nor will it be ever opened
before the high King's doom.
Then it will be seen,
460 as the Psalm sayeth,
Reddituri sunt de factis propriis
rationem.
Then shall those servants
tell their deeds,
truly through wisdom,
465 for the Lord knoweth them;
then they receive their doom
from the Lord's mouth,
as it is written;
from the Lord's mouth:
Ite maledicti in ignem eternum.
470 Then shall we depart
into uttermost sorrow,
go with fiends
in that everlasting fire,

beornen æfre.	475	to burn for ever;
ende nis ther nefre.		end is there never.
<i>Et quia bona egerunt ibunt in</i>		<i>Et quia bona egerunt ibunt in</i>
<i>vitam eternam.</i>		<i>vitam eternam.</i>
thonne gon theo goden.		Then go the good,
mid Gode sithian.		departing with God,
echeliche wunien.	480	to dwell everlastingly
in alre wuldre.		in ever-during glory.
* * * * *		* * * * *
* * * me suke to the.		* * * * *
<i>Osmeum aperui, et attraxi ipsum.</i>		<i>Osmeum aperui, et attraxi ipsum.</i>
thu * * * et drowe me to the.	485	thou * * * drew me to thee,
walawa! and wa is me.		well away! and woe is me!
that ic efre com to the.		that I ever came to thee;
for noldest <i>thu</i> mid thine muthe.		for thou wouldst not with thy
bimænen thine neode.		mouth
ac æfre dizelliche.	490	bewail thy infirmities;
thu woldest <i>ham</i> bidernan.		but ever darkly
noldest thu <i>ham</i> siggen.		thou wouldst hide them;
biforen none preosten.		nor wouldst thou confess them;
ther <i>alle</i> men secheth <i>ham</i> ore.		before any priest,
bimæneth hore misdeden.	495	where all men seek pardon,
and seoththen <i>miltsunge</i> foth.		bewail their misdeeds,
thurh sothne scrift.		and afterwards obtain mercy;
sithieth to Criste.		through true shrift
seggeth hore sunnen.		depart to Christ;
and hor <i>soules</i> helpith.	500	confess their sins
thurh sothe bireousunge.		and help their souls,
theo soule reste onfoth.		through true repentance.
ac ne the <i>scalt</i> nefre resten.		the soul acquires rest;
thurh thine bireousunge.		but thou shalt never rest,
ac altogædere ic am forloren.	505	through thy repentance.
		Eke I am altogether lost

thurh thine luthere deden.
noldest thu mid muthe.
bidden me none miltsunge.
nu thu ert adumbed.
and death haueth the keiȝe.
mid clutes thu ert forligden.
and loth alle freonden.
efre ma eft.
on to lokienne.
thus is reoulliche *thin* sith.
efter thine wrecche lif.
for thu were beset.
thicke mid sunne.
and alle *theo* weren prickiende.
so wiles on ile.
he bith thicke mid wiles.
ne prikieth heom no wiht.
for al bith that softe.
iwend to him sulfen.
that ne mawen his wiles.
prikien him sore.
for al bith that scearpe.
him iwend fromward.
So thu *weren* mid sunne.
iset alle with inne.
theo sunfule pikes.
prikieth me fulsore.
ac thu al that softe was.
iwend to the sulven.
and efre thet scerpe.
scored me touardes.
heo weren iwend.
so me wurst was.

through thy wicked deeds;
thou wouldst not with thy mouth
pray for mercy to me;
now thou art bedumbed,
510 and death has caught thee;
thou art laid out with rags,
and loath to all thy friends,
for ever and ever
to look on.
515 Thus rueful is thy lot,
after thy wicked life;
for thou wert beset
thick with sin,
and they all were pricking
520 like quills on porcupine;
he is thick set with quills;
they prick him not,
for the soft part is all
turned to himself,
525 that his quills cannot
prick him sore,
for the points are all
turned him fromward.
Thus thou wert with sin
530 beset all within;
those sinful pikes
prick me full sore,
but thou all that was soft
turned to thyself,
535 and ever the sharp
scored me towards,
they were turned
as was worst for me,

ich was mid thine prickunge.
ipined *fulsore*.

ac nu me wulleth prikien.
theo pikes inne helle.
pinion me ful sore.
for thine sunne.

Ic was on heihnes isceapen.
and soule ihoten.

Ic was the seofothe isceaft.

So theo bec seggeth.

the the Almihti God.

mildeliche iwrouhte.

wisliche mid worde.

so hit al iwearth.

heouene and eorthe.

luft and engles.

wind and watere.

thæs monnes soule.

this beoth theo seouene.

the ic ær foreseide.

this was *makede*.

thæs Almihties fæder.

of thissen andweorke.

alle thing he iwrouhte.

and thus hit is iwruten.

on holie wisdom.

Fiat et facta sunt omnia.

He seide iwurthe.

and alle thing iworthen.

thus mid one worde.

al hit was iwurthen.

he iscop thonne thene sune.

alle isceafte wisliche.

540

I was with the pricking
pained ful sore:

but now will prick me
those pikes in hell;
punish me full sore
for thy sin.

545

On high was I created,
and named soul.

I was the seventh creation,
as the book says,

that Almighty God

550

mercifully wrought.

Truly by his word

thus it all came to pass:

heaven and earth,

air and angels,

555

wind and water,

the soul of man,

these are the seven

that I before mentioned.

These were made

560

by the Almighty Father;

of this substance

all things he wrought;

and thus it is written

in holy wisdom,

565

Fiat et facta sunt omnia.

He said, let be,

and all things were;

thus with one word

was all created;

570

he made then the sun,

all truly created

thurh wisdom.
 and efre he hit wiseth.
Imaginem et similitudinem.
 and ic deorewurthe.
 drihtenes onlicnesse.
 * * * * *
 * * * * of God.
 and ic the imæne.
 mid lothre lufe.
 and ic thin wale iwearth.
 hu so *thu noldest*.
 weila thine fule iwill.
 wo haveth hit me idon.
 Thu fule mathe *mæte*.
 hwi hauest thou me biswiken.
 For thine fule sunne.
 ic scal nu *in helle*.
 dreizen ther wrecche sith.
 all for thine fule lif.
 3et ic wulle the ætwinne.
and thine wea sithes.
 Nu ic scal soriliche.
 sithien from the.
 nu beoth thine teth atru.
thin tunge is ascorted.
 theo the facen was.
 and then feonde icweme.
 Mid wowe *dreames*.
 and mid gultes feole.
thu othre birefedest.
 rihtes istreones.
 gæderest to * * * ime.
 ac hit is nu all igon.

by his wisdom,
 and he guides it ever,
Imaginem et similitudinem.
 575 And I, in the dear
 Lord's likeness.
 * * * * *
 * * * * of God,
 and me between,
 580 with pure love,
 and I thy bliss decreed;
 how so thou wouldst not;
 alas! thy foul will
 hath wrought my woe.
 585 Thou foul food for worms,
 why hast thou deceived me?
 For thy wicked sin
 I shall now in hell
 suffer there a wretched time,
 590 all for thy wicked life;
 yet I will flee thee
 and thy dreary fate.
 Now I shall sorrowfully
 depart from thee;
 595 thy teeth are now poisonous;
 thy tongue is shortened,
 which was so deceitful
 and pleasing to the fiend.
 With unjust judgments,
 600 and with many trespasses,
 thou bereaved others
 of their rightful wealth,
 gatheredest * * *
 but it is now all gone

thurh thæs deofles lore.
the the licode wel.
Nu lith thin *bodige* stille.
on ful colde denne.
nafest thu gaersume themo.
the heo was spekinde.
for heo was faken biforen.
and atterne bihinden.
heo demde feole domes.
the drihten *was* lothe.
Iseid hit is on psalme.
and ful sothe hit is bihire.
Lingua tua concinnabat dolos.
Heo 3eothede fakenliche.
and then feonde icwemde.
heo heou mid hearde worde.
and *icwemde* tha wrecches.
scearpe heo was and kene.
and cwemde then deofle.
mid alle then sunne.
that efre was his wille.
A wurthe hire wa.
that heo spekinde was so.
heo haueth unc *domned*.
to deoppere helle.
Nis hit non sellic.
thauh ic segge of boken.
thauh ic *thonne* that sothe repie.
for ic was ilered.
of mine leoue fæder.
feire on frumthe.
aer ic *fordferde*.
ic was Godes douhter.

605 through the devil's lore,
that thou liked so well.
Now lieth thy body still
in full cold den;
nor hast thou the treasure
610 of which she spake;
for she was deceitful before,
and envenomed after;
she pronounced many judgments
that were hateful to the Lord.
615 It is said in the Psalm,
and full true it is of her:
Lingua tua concinnabat dolos.
She poured out deceitfully,
and pleased the fiend;
620 she hewed with hard words,
and delighted the wretches.
Sharp she was and keen,
and pleased the devil
with all the sin
625 that ever was his will.
Wo be to her!
that she spake so;
she has damned us
to deeper hell.
630 Is it not wonderful,
though I read in books,
though I then the truth gathered,
for I was taught
by my dear father
635 beautifully in the beginning,
before I departed,
I was God's daughter,

ac thu amerdest that foster.
 ic sceolde lif holden.
me sellethe he wolde.
 Sone thu were lifleas.
 seoththen ic the forleas.
 Ic was thin imake.
 so so bec seggeth.
Uxor tua sicut vitis habundans.
 Ic was the biwedded.
 wurthliche * * * e.
 et then fontstone.
 that thu haucst ifuled.
 mid thine fule othes.
 Thu hafest thin fulluht forloren.
 behinden and biuoren.
 Feire thu were imerked.
 heie on thine heafde.
mid then holie ele.
 Thu hauest kine merke.
 thu scoldest beon on heouene.
 heih * * * under Gode.
 3if thu hit ne forlure.
 thuruh thæs deofles lore.
 Thine godfæderes *ihaten*.
 ær heo the forleten.
 that thu me scoldest holden.
 thuruh holie lufe Cristes.
 and *drihtene* lawe.
 ledene me to Criste.
 Thu withsoke thene deofel.
 efter drihtenes *cwithe*.
 his modes and his wrænches.

but thou didst hinder that
 fostering.
 I might life have held,
 640 that he would have given me.
 Soon thou wert lifeless,
 sithence I left thee.
 I was thy wife,
 as the book says:
 645 *Uxor tua sicut vitis habundans.*
 I was wedded to thee
 honourably,
 at the fount stone,
 that thou hast defiled
 650 with thy foul oaths.
 Thou hast forfeited thy baptism
 here and hereafter.
 Fair thou wert marked,
 high on thy head,
 655 with the holy oil
 Thou hadst the mark of royalty;
 thou mightst have been in heaven,
 high * * * under God,
 if thou hadst not forfeited it
 660 through the devil's lore.
 Thy godfathers promised,
 before they relinquished thee,
 that thou shouldst keep me
 in Christ's holy love
 665 and the law of God,
 and lead me to Christ.
 Thou renounced the devil,
 (after the Lord's word,)
 his moods, and his deceits,

and his wíeles thæрто.
Seoththen thu hine lufedest.
and forwinne drihten.
for thu lufedest theo lawen.
the drihten weren lothe.
unker team *forloren*.
the wit scolden teman.
so ic was the betæiht.
that wit scolden teman.
Thu *hauest* beon bearne fæder.
and ic hore moder.
wit scolden fostrien bearn.
and bring *ham* to Criste.
Thet beoth theos bearn.
so so bec mæneth.

Filii tui sicut novell * * *

670 and his wiles thereto.
Afterwards thou lovedst him,
and rebelled against the Lord,
for thou lovedst the traitors
that were hateful to God;
675 our progeny lost
that we should bring forth;
as I was given to thee
that we might propagate.
Thou hast been father of children,
680 and I their mother;
we should foster our progeny,
and bring them to Christ.
These are the children
that the book mentions:

Filii tui sicut novell * * *

Cetera desunt.

[A] Wrecche?

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Nº 5

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